

RESOLVE MUN - LOK SABHA

BACKGROUND GUIDE

AGENDA- Deliberation on the recent developments in border security with special emphasis on India's trade relations and foreign policy amidst the West Asian conflict with recent developments.

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A Letter from The Executive Board

Respected Members, We, as the chair for the Lok Sabha simulation at **RESOLVE MUN MUN,2026**, whole-heartedly welcome each and every single one of you, to this unconventional, yet, the most important Committee.

With the help of this Background Guide, towards the Agenda, we as the Executive Board, aim to give you a starting point, a base, for your research and most importantly, a base for the Lok Sabha, to forbid clarifications.

Delegates, although the Committee might be unconventional, it is still one of the most relevant and the most important committees in the Modern Era.

This is where your research comes in and we would like to reiterate here, that this Background Guide is **only to be used for reference**. Please don't limit or consider your research done after going through the Background Guides contents.

This is - simply a starting point. Looking forward to hosting the best committee at **RESOLVE MUN**, The one, the only, The Lok Sabha.

Regards

Manan Garg (speaker)

Aarnav(deputy speaker)

Ahmed (scribe)

Preamble to the constitution of India

THE CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

PREAMBLE

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a '**[SOVEREIGN SOCIALIST SECULAR DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC]**' and to secure to all its citizens :

JUSTICE, social, economic and political;

LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship;

EQUALITY of status and of opportunity and to promote among them all;

FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the individual and the ²[unity and integrity of the Nation];

IN OUR CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY this twenty-sixth day of November, 1949 do **HEREBY ADOPT, ENACT AND GIVE TO OURSELVES THIS CONSTITUTION.**

1. Subs. by the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, Sec.2, for "Sovereign Democratic Republic" (w.e.f. 3.1.1977)
2. Subs. by the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, Sec.2, for "Unity of the Nation" (w.e.f. 3.1.1977)

INTRODUCTION

India is experiencing a paradigm shift in its national security environment, characterized by traditional border issues but also by fast-evolving global geopolitical dynamics. Until recently a concept tied primarily to physical defense, penetration, and national sovereignty the term border security has come to encompass not only surveillance technology and internal stability but also cross-border crime and the protection of critical infrastructure. Simultaneously, changes in West Asia have also added a new dimension of complexity for India since West Asia is connected to India through energy supplies, trade routes, migrant workers and long-standing diplomatic ties. A worsening in the West Asian conflict may bring with it disruption to shipping lanes, higher import prices, foreign policy options and security questions far beyond the area involved.

The agenda here aims to discuss how India should react to the border security developments against the backdrop of increasing instability in West Asia, and what steps it can take to safeguard its economic and strategic interests. The problem is not merely military preparedness—though that is perhaps the most prominent aspect—but also one of economic resilience, diplomatic balancing, maritime security, and India's image as a responsible regional power. It is hence interesting to expect that delegates analyze the connection between domestic security and foreign diplomacy, examine how West Asian conflict can affect Indian strategic interests and consider what kind of policy reaction would most protect India's sovereignty, economy and global leadership role in such a volatile international landscape.

Border Security in India: Recent Developments

Border security is one of the biggest issues in India in terms of national security debate because of its location. It is not just stuck in line with some map: it also fights infiltrations, smuggling and drone-based threats, protects civilians living near the border and has learned to use technology against new types of cross-border risk. In the case of a country like India, with its geographically sensitive neighbourhood many of whom do not share cordial relations with New Delhi, border management is procedurally intertwined with internal security, economic prosperity and foreign policy.

India has moved from a manpower-based model of border security to a technology and coordination based one, becoming clear about their approach now. It has also earmarked the “Smart Border Project” that includes the use of drones, radars, modern cameras and surveillance systems, and better coordination among BSF, state police, district administrations and other agencies. Border security is therefore now treated as an issue of territory and administration, not just military responsibility.

Why border security matters

India has long, diverse and hard to police frontiers. Stretches which run through deserts, riverine areas, dense forests, marshes and high-altitude mountain regions make such surveillance and rapid response nearly impossible. This geography implies that border management has to contend with both natural challenges but also human threats, including infiltration, arms trafficking, narcotics smuggling and illegal cross-border movement. That border, which safeguards India in so many ways, also remains prone to abuse by adversarial forces in various places.

That's also why border security matters because seldom threats nowadays are only militaristic. Weaseling without a declaration of war, smuggling networks / drone deliveries / fake currency / cyber-linked coordination and cross-border crime could even disintegrate internal stability. This explains to a degree why the Home Ministry has increasingly talked about "territorial security" and a "security grid", rather than

just border fencing. To put it more bluntly, the border has become viewed as the first line of India's internal security architecture.

Recent developments

The biggest recent development being the push by the government for a Smart Border framework. In official parlance, the objective is to drive technology into border management through drones, radars and surveillance cameras and better intelligence coordination. This follows the increase in threats like infiltration, drug trafficking and drone smuggling. It is also signalled in the government that the method of guarding the border, which was used for a long time, is not sufficient in modern threats.

One of the other important evolutions is that border security thinking has moved from just police agencies to local communities and civil administration. The Home Minister underlined that border security cannot act in isolation but it requires district officials, police stations, panchayats and local coordination mechanisms. It signifies a policy shift to manage borders with communities, especially in sensitive areas like West Bengal, Assam, Tripura and bordering-Pakistan. It also indicates an implication by the state to make border control a collaborative governance responsibility.

Border policy has also become central to infrastructure development. It has opened many projects implemented by the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) in terms of construction of roads, bridges and other border infrastructure in border states and UTs. Improved logistics and infrastructure enable the armed forces to better move, accelerate supply chains, and increase speed of deployment in emergencies. Thus, on the one hand such projects contribute to civilian development in the remote border regions.

Main threats

India's border threat landscape is more diverse today than ever before. Places where illegal infiltration is a problem, because the borders are porous or difficult to fence. In parallel, security agencies are facing the challenges of narcotics and cattle smuggling, counterfeit currency and arms trafficking. These acts are criminal, but they are also strategic because they can finance networks that challenge the authority of the state.

This new kind of threat is serious and it has arrived: drones. Drones are dropping weapons, drugs and other contraband on the side of the border making it impractical to only depend upon fencing and patrols. Authorities' response has been to enhance detection systems and bolster inter-agency collaboration. This development is particularly significant as it demonstrates that while geography continues to play a role, technology is what shapes the nature of border security.

The border fight is also driven by demographic and political fears. By associating infiltration with demographic disruption, public disorder, and even terrorism, the government has made border management a politically mobilizing issue. Such language is commonly employed when rallying the public behind more stringent enforcement, but may also exacerbate political controversy over immigration, civil liberties and federal coordination. Delegates should realize that border security is not just a security question; it is also one with great political overtones.

Political angle

In India, border security is highly politicized. When anxiety rises, governments often brandish tough border policy as evidence of decisiveness, sovereignty and control. But time, in turn, has seen opposition parties ask whether security measures work or are proportional and honour the federal balancing act while respecting civil liberties. So border security becomes both an election issue and policy issue.

It also has a federal aspect. It's the neighbouring states which are most affected by infiltration, smuggling and pressure on security demands more assistance, better

infrastructure and demand more consultations from the Centre. The Union and the states have to work in coordination, especially since local police/state governments/central forces are all working together. In the debate in committee, it is possible to raise this as who should be responsible for border failures and who should determine the policy response.

The political backdrop is also tied up with India's larger security strategy. A recent statement from across the government indicates that this mindset clearly includes a view of border management as an instrument against terrorism, hybrid warfare, and internal destabilization. This means that border policy can no longer be seen simply as a highly specific matter of administration but as an issue directly about national sovereignty. The frame can help organise delegations' arguments in relation to issues and not only for conventional issues like surveillance, force expansion, technology use.

Why these changes happen

Such developments are taking place because the face of threat has changed.

Previously, it was largely over physical trespass or conventional military friction, but these days border security addresses asymmetric and tech-enabled threats. The new weak surveillance, treacherous terrain and terrible coordination can be exploited by smugglers, traffickers and hostile networks rapidly. In response, the state will have needed to evolve its approach.

Another factor is that India has come to view borders as part of its own security system, since internal order. Crime, community tension, gun and drug trafficking, even poverty will suffer from unauthorised movement across the borders. Thus, the border is more than a territorial defense line; it is also a bulwark against wider state collapse. This also helps to explain the simultaneous government investments in technology, infrastructure and multi-agency coordination.

Points for delegates

A few of the major questions delegates can consider when deliberating border security. Firstly, does India need to lean on technology —or still is it important that human intelligence and local coordination matter more? But should border security be treated primarily as a defence issue or as a development issue? Third, how much tighter borders could the government tighten before creating collateral damage to nearby civilians?

One of the useful flavors for debate is whether India needs hard borders or smart borders. A hard border hinges on fencing, patrols and hard deterrence while a smart border relies on surveillance, data, drones and inter-agency coordination. India probably will need both, but the real argument is over balance, expense and political fallout.

Relevance to agenda

This part of the agenda connects directly with the rest of the committee because border security cannot be separated from trade, diplomacy, and conflict in West Asia. If trade routes are disrupted, if shipping becomes unsafe, or if diplomatic tensions rise, border and internal security pressures also increase. That is why a discussion on border security must include both India's immediate frontiers and the wider strategic environment around them.

India's trade relation and foreign policy

1. Why West Asia matters to India

West Asia (broadly the Gulf, Iran, Israel, etc.) is one of India's most critical external regions.

- **Energy:** Around half of India's crude oil and LNG imports and more than four-fifths of LPG imports come from West Asia, largely through the Strait of Hormuz, making the region central to India's energy security and price stability.
- **Trade and shipping:** India's trade and energy supply chains physically traverse the Gulf; any disruption in sea lanes or attacks on merchant shipping directly threaten India's economy.
- **People and remittances:** Roughly 10 million Indian citizens live and work in the Gulf; their safety, employment, and remittances are vital for India's economy and domestic politics.

These structural linkages mean any conflict in West Asia, especially around the Gulf and Iran, automatically becomes a border security, economic security, and foreign policy issue for India.

2. The current West Asia conflict and India's official stance

The current phase of the West Asia conflict (escalation around Iran and the Gulf in early 2026) has led to direct statements from the Government of India highlighting security and economic concerns.

- The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) explicitly noted that India is a “proximate neighbour” with “critical stakes in the security and stability of the region,” flagging the deterioration of the situation and its spread to other countries.

- India has emphasized three ideas: restraint and de-escalation by all parties, protection of civilians, and a strong preference for dialogue and diplomacy to bring an early end to the conflict.

Delegates should note that India is publicly projecting itself as a stakeholder in regional stability, while trying to avoid taking sides in a way that would endanger its diverse partnerships in the region.

3. Immediate trade and shipping impacts

The conflict has had direct implications for India's trade relations and maritime security.

1. Energy supplies and prices

- Since most of India's oil and gas imports from West Asia pass through chokepoints like the Strait of Hormuz, military activity and attacks in the Gulf raise insurance costs, shipping risks, and potential supply disruptions.
- Any major disruption is recognized by MEA as having "serious consequences for the Indian economy," linking conflict directly to domestic inflation, fiscal stress, and current account pressures.

2. Merchant shipping and Indian seafarers

- India has publicly opposed attacks on merchant shipping, noting that some Indian nationals have been killed or gone missing due to recent incidents at sea, showing that the conflict has already had tangible human and economic costs for India.
- New Delhi's statements frame safe sea lines of communication (SLOCs) as a national interest priority, tying together trade security, diaspora safety, and broader maritime strategy.

3. Recalibration of trade routes and projects

- The conflict undermines large connectivity projects like the India–Middle East–Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) and complicates

India's efforts to use Iranian ports such as Chabahar as alternative routes to Europe and Central Asia.

- Ongoing volatility forces India to diversify energy sources and use long-term contracts, while also exploring non-West Asian suppliers, which in turn affects existing trade volumes and bargaining power with Gulf partners.

These developments give delegates concrete hooks to debate how much India should hedge, diversify, or double down on West Asian partnerships.

4. India's foreign policy posture in West Asia

4.1 Long-term evolution

India's West Asia policy has historically moved through phases: early solidarity with Arab causes, later pragmatic diversification, and more recently a multi-alignment approach engaging Israel, Gulf monarchies, and Iran simultaneously.

- Economic and trade ties with Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) states have grown significantly and now underpin India's broader strategic engagement with West Asia.
- India has simultaneously deepened security cooperation, including counterterrorism and defence partnerships, while still trying to avoid entanglement in intra-regional rivalries (for example between Iran and some Arab states).

4.2 Changes in the last decade

Over the last ten years, observers note key shifts in India's approach: more high-level visits, institutionalized economic and security dialogues, and a stronger emphasis on balancing ties with multiple rival actors.

- India has engaged closely with Israel and key Gulf states (like the UAE and Saudi Arabia), while maintaining working relations with Iran for energy, connectivity, and strategic depth.

- This balancing act, sometimes described as a “strategic balance,” is now being tested by the latest conflict, as India must respond to escalations without jeopardizing key partnerships or appearing to endorse any one side.

Delegates can frame this as a stress-test of India’s “multi-alignment” doctrine: can India keep all its West Asian partners on board during a major conflict?

5. India’s diplomacy in the current conflict

Analyses of India’s diplomacy in the ongoing conflict note certain patterns and dilemmas.

- Some commentaries argue that four weeks into the conflict, India’s diplomacy shows signs of tactical alignment with the United States and Israel on specific security issues, while still publicly emphasizing de-escalation and humanitarian concerns.
- At the same time, other assessments stress that India needs to restore strategic balance—meaning it should avoid over-identifying with any one bloc, given its deep ties with the Gulf, Iran, and Western partners.

India’s policy tools in this context include high-level phone calls by the Prime Minister and External Affairs Minister, coordinated MEA statements, and active engagement with regional governments to protect Indian nationals and sustain trade and energy flows.

This gives the committee room to debate whether India should:

- maintain strict neutrality,
 - practice “issue-based” alignment (for example, on maritime security), or
 - openly side with a particular bloc to secure strategic benefits.
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6. Border security, internal security, and economic stability

Even though the conflict is geographically in West Asia, it has direct implications for India's border and internal security.

- Energy and trade disruptions can strain India's economy, potentially impacting defence spending, border infrastructure, and domestic political stability, thereby indirectly affecting border security.
- India's previous experience with cross-border terrorism, as noted in official documents, has already inclined it to see West Asian instability as a source of radicalization, illicit flows, and terrorism networks, making regional turmoil a security concern beyond just economics.

Delegates can examine whether India's border security policies should now explicitly integrate energy and maritime security in West Asia as part of a broader "comprehensive national security" framework.

7. Key questions and blocs for committee debate

To help structure debate, you could divide delegates into broad idea-blocs, each with a different prescription for India's trade and foreign policy response.

Potential lines of debate (all grounded in the above facts):

- **Bloc A – Strategic neutrality and diversification**
 - Argues for strict neutrality, maximizing diplomatic space while aggressively diversifying energy suppliers and trade partners to reduce overdependence on West Asia.
- **Bloc B – Proactive maritime and energy security**
 - Focuses on naval deployments, stronger anti-piracy and anti-terror frameworks in the Gulf, and robust bilateral and multilateral arrangements to protect merchant shipping and Indian nationals.
- **Bloc C – Deeper alignment with key partners**
 - Argues that India should leverage closer alignment with particular regional or extra-regional powers (for example, key Gulf partners, the

US, or Israel) to secure long-term energy deals, investments, and defence cooperation, even at the cost of reduced flexibility elsewhere.

- **Bloc D – Normative and humanitarian focus**

- Emphasizes India's role as a responsible power, stressing international law, protection of civilians, and the importance of diplomacy, while arguing that trade and foreign policy must be conditioned on conflict de-escalation and human security.

You can also set specific sub-issues:

- Should India prioritize energy security or normative consistency in its West Asia policy?
- To what extent should India's border and internal security planning explicitly factor in maritime and energy vulnerabilities in West Asia?

WEST ASIAN CONFLICT AND RECENT DEVELOPMENTS

1. The Gaza Strip Genesis (October 2023–October 2025)

The immediate root of the current instability stems from more than two years of devastating conflict in the Gaza Strip between October 2023 and October 2025. During this initial phase, the localized conflict resulted in catastrophic humanitarian loss and structural damage, culminating in over 71,000 Palestinian fatalities and more than 171,000 injuries.

A joint Rapid Damage and Needs Assessment (RDNA) compiled by the World Bank, the United Nations, and the European Union detailed the immense scale of physical destruction and economic losses during this period:

Although a formal ceasefire agreement was reached on October 9, 2025, and subsequently endorsed by UN Security Council Resolution 2803 which established a transitional administration known as the "Board of Peace" the peace remained fragile. Post-ceasefire violence persisted, and by mid-January 2026, an additional 449 Palestinians had been killed and 1,246 injured.

2. Regional Escalation (Early 2026)

The localized conflict transformed into a wider regional war in early 2026, characterized by direct hostilities involving Israel, the United States, and Iran. This culminated in a US-Israeli bombing campaign targeting Iranian territory in late February 2026, which prompted emergency closed consultations in the UN Security Council regarding the ongoing attacks on civilian infrastructure, educational, and health facilities.

3. The Maritime Blockade and Strait of Hormuz Crisis

The escalation immediately cantered on the region's critical maritime chokepoints, particularly the Strait of Hormuz and the Red Sea/Suez Canal corridor. The Strait of

Hormuz, which historically handled approximately 20% of global seaborne petroleum and liquefied natural gas (LNG) supplies, became a primary choke point.

Following the outbreak of hostilities, the waterway was heavily blockaded, causing daily commercial vessel transits to plunge from over 100 ships to between just two and sixteen. By late April 2026, a fragile ceasefire was brokered between the United States and Iran. While this temporary agreement eased fears of an all-out nuclear or regional ground war, it did not resolve the shipping blockade or security threats surrounding the Strait. Up to 20,000 seafarers remained stranded aboard approximately 2,000 merchant vessels in the Persian Gulf, unable to navigate the blockaded waters safely.

To address the maritime stalemate, the United Nations Secretary-General established a dedicated Task Force in March 2026, led by Under Secretary-General Jorge Moreira da Silva (Executive Director of UNOPS), alongside representatives from UNCTAD, the International Maritime Organization (IMO), and the International Chamber of Commerce. Drawing on historical frameworks like the Black Sea Grain Initiative and the UN Verification, Inspection and Monitoring Mechanism for Yemen, this Task Force sought to establish a technical monitoring and verification mechanism to facilitate the safe passage of critical cargoes, particularly fertilizers, through the Strait of Hormuz, while Jean Arnault, the Personal Envoy for the Middle East, led regional diplomatic negotiations.

Global Macroeconomic and Multi-Sectoral Consequences

The blockade of West Asian maritime corridors has severely impacted the global economy, halting the disinflationary trend observed since 2023 and driving down global growth projections.

1. Global Economic Slowdown & High Inflation (UN DESA Projections)

According to the UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs (DESA) Mid-2026 report, global economic growth is projected to slow to 2.5% in 2026, with a modest recovery to 2.8% projected for 2027. The economic impact is highly uneven:

- Western Asia: Growth is projected to plunge to 1.4% in 2026 (down from 3.6% in 2025) due to direct infrastructure destruction, tourism declines, and oil production cuts.
- European Union: Projected to slow from 1.5% in 2025 to 1.1% in 2026 due to heavy reliance on imported energy.
- United Kingdom: Faces a steep moderation from 1.4% to 0.7%.
- United States: Remains comparatively resilient at 2.0% in 2026, supported by robust consumer demand and AI investments.
- China: Diversified energy mix and strategic reserves provide a buffer, with growth moderating to 4.6% in 2026.
- Developed Economies (Inflation): Forecast to rise to 2.9% in 2026, edging further above central bank targets.
- Developing Economies (Inflation): Projected to experience a sharper uptick to 5.2% in 2026, driven by high import, transport, and energy costs.

2. Labor Markets and Remittances (ILO Projections)

The International Labour Organization (ILO), in its Employment and Social Trends: May 2026 Update, characterized the crisis as a slow-moving, long-lasting shock. Under an illustrative scenario where oil prices remain 50% above their early 2026 average:

- Global Working Hours: Projected to fall by 0.5% in 2026 and by 1.1% in 2027.
- Equivalent Job Losses: This contraction is equivalent to the loss of 14 million full-time equivalent jobs in 2026 and 38 million in 2027.
- Global Labor Incomes: Projected to decrease by 1.1% in 2026 (representing a loss of USD 1.1 trillion) and by 3% in 2027 (representing a loss of USD 3 trillion).

- Asia-Pacific Impact: Working hours are projected to decline by 0.7% in 2026 and 1.5% in 2027, with real labour income falling by 1.5% in 2026 and 4.3% in 2027. Remittance flows are weakening as labour deployments to Gulf countries decline sharply.

3: Multi-Sectoral Vulnerabilities of the Republic of India

The West Asian conflict has had direct, widespread effects on India, impacting the country's macroeconomic growth, trade logistics, and the safety of its large diaspora.

1. Macroeconomic and Trade Strain

Although India's economy remains relatively resilient, its projected GDP growth is expected to step down from 7.5% in 2025 to 6.4% in 2026. This deceleration is directly attributed to the drag from elevated energy import costs and tighter financial conditions.

India's Export-Import (EXIM) trade bound for Europe and the Western hemisphere relies heavily on the Red Sea route and the Suez Canal. The threat of maritime attacks and the subsequent spike in freight and insurance costs have significantly reduced the competitiveness of Indian exports. Key domestic sectors that depend on this passage have been highly vulnerable to these supply chain disruptions:

- Agricultural Products: Perishable nature makes delayed transits highly costly; delays degrade quality, leading to contract cancellations.
- Steel & Engineering: High volume-to-weight ratio, dependent on dry-bulk transport; skyrocketing ocean freight rates erode global pricing edge.
- Automobiles: Complex just-in-time supply chains, specialized vehicle carriers; component delays stall assembly lines.
- Textiles & Chemicals: Direct shipping links to European and Western retail markets; strained shipping margins, delayed inventory cycles.

Despite these headwinds, Indian exporters achieved a record export total of over USD 820 billion in fiscal year 2024-25. However, future growth is constrained by rising non-tariff and protectionist measures, such as the EU and UK Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM), EU Deforestation Regulations, and the EU's Eco-design Sustainable Products Regulation (ESPR) set to take effect from January 1, 2026.

2. The Security and Humanitarian Emergency of the Indian Diaspora

The most critical immediate challenge for India has been safeguarding its citizens. More than 1 crore (10 million) Indian nationals reside, study, and work in West Asian and Gulf countries. During the peak of the USA-Israel-Iran hostilities, Indian citizens faced immediate danger:

- **Casualties:** 5 deceased Indian nationals (4 in Oman, 1 in Iraq) and 25 injured across the UAE (17), Oman (5), Qatar (1), Israel (1), and Saudi Arabia (1).
- **Missing Mariners:** 1 Indian seafarer was reported missing from a merchant vessel off the coast.
- **Tehran Student Relocation:** Approximately 800 Indian students were relocated outside Tehran and facilitated in their departure from Iran through land borders.
- **Total Repatriations:** By March 25, 2026, India had facilitated the emergency return of over 4.75 lakh (475,000) Indian nationals from West Asia and the Gulf region, utilizing commercial flights and non-scheduled operations.

3. Energy Logistics Vulnerability

The conflict has exposed a critical structural vulnerability in India's energy logistics: over 90% of India's crude oil imports are transported on foreign-flagged vessels. During global crises, this dependency leaves India highly vulnerable to foreign shipping companies withdrawing services, refusing to transit volatile zones, or charging exorbitant war-risk premiums.

India's Strategic and Tactical Responses

To overcome the challenges of the West Asian conflict and protect its developmental trajectory, India has transitioned from reactive emergency management to structural, long-term defensive planning.

1. Safe Evacuation of Citizens and Diaspora Protection

- **Special Control Room:** The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) established a dedicated 24/7 Special Control Room in New Delhi to monitor the situation, respond to queries, and coordinate with regional embassies. By March 26, 2026, the control room had addressed 1,112 phone calls and 265 emails (up from 939 calls and 195 emails on March 13).
- **High-Frequency Advisories:** The Indian Embassy in Tehran issued a sequence of targeted safety and relocation advisories (specifically on January 23, February 28, March 3, March 9, and March 16, 2026) to manage student safety and facilitate land-border exits.
- **Transit Visa Facilitation:** For countries where airspaces were closed, Indian missions coordinated with neighboring states to secure transit visas and local transport, allowing citizens to board commercial flights in safe zones.

2. Energy Security and Import Diversification

- **Supplier Expansion:** Over the past eleven years, India has expanded its sources of crude oil, LNG, and LPG imports from 27 countries to 41 countries, greatly reducing its vulnerability to disruptions in any single geographical zone.
- **Strategic Petroleum Reserves (SPR):** India has built and filled SPR facilities containing over 53 lakh (5.3 million) metric tonnes of crude oil, while actively executing Phase II expansion plans to develop another 65 lakh (6.5 million) metric tonnes of storage capacity.

- Domestic Grids: On the domestic front, the government has accelerated the rollout of Piped Natural Gas (PNG) connections to household consumers to substitute for imported LPG, while ramping up domestic exploration and production of gas to insulate the domestic market.

3. The ₹70,000 Crore Shipbuilding Campaign (Atmanirbhar Shipping)

To eliminate its dangerous dependence on foreign-flagged shipping lines, the Government of India launched a comprehensive shipbuilding policy package of approximately ₹70,000 crore in September 2025, designed around the government's "four pillar approach."

- Tripartite MoU for Thoothukudi Mega Greenfield Shipyard: Signed on April 20, 2026, under the India-ROK Comprehensive Framework 'VOYAGES' (Shared Vision for Operation of Yard Assisted Growth with Efficiency and Scale). The agreement—between HD Korea Shipbuilding & Offshore Engineering, the National Shipbuilding & Heavy Industries Park of Tamil Nadu (NSHIP-TN), and Sagarmala Finance Corporation Limited—will establish a Mega Greenfield Shipyard in Thoothukudi, Tamil Nadu. This facility, representing an annual capacity of 2.5 million Gross Tonnage (GT), will serve as the anchor of a comprehensive maritime manufacturing cluster, localizing marine equipment manufacturing and advanced green shipping technologies while generating 15,000 direct jobs.
- Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047 (MAKV 2047) Targets: The vision aims to position India among the top five shipbuilding nations globally by the year 2047, targeting a commercial shipbuilding output of 4.5 million GT per annum. The Thoothukudi facility will contribute more than half of this target.
- Right of First Refusal (RoFR) Licensing Revision: The Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways revised its RoFR tender guidelines to prioritize domestic ship building and ownership. The revised hierarchy is :

1. Indian built, Indian flagged, and Indian owned.

2. Indian built, Indian flagged, and Indian IFSCA (International Financial Services Centres Authority) owned.

3. Foreign built, Indian flagged, and Indian owned.

4. Foreign built, Indian flagged, and Indian IFSCA owned.

5. Indian built, foreign flagged, and foreign owned.

- Shipbuilding Financial Assistance Policy (SBFAP): Operating from April 1, 2016, to March 31, 2026, SBFAP provides financial assistance to domestic yards, starting at 20% in 2016 and diminishing to 11% in 2026. Since its inception, 39 shipyards have secured 313 vessel orders valued at approximately ₹10,500 crore. Recent guidelines were amended to include wind farm installation vessels and sophisticated dredgers as specialized vessels eligible for higher assistance exceeding the ₹40 crore cap for non-specialized vessels.

4. Trade Route Resiliency: The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC)

India is prioritizing the development of the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC), which is designed to encompass railways, roadways, energy pipelines, and clean energy undersea cables. Projections indicate that the corridor will reduce logistics costs by up to 30% and transportation transit time by 40%.

India has proposed a structured approach to advance this initiative:

- Public-Private Partnership (PPP) Model: India advocates for a private sector-led development model to ensure efficiency and financial viability.
- Financial and Regulatory Integration: India is proposing the adoption of common digital payment systems modeled on India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) to reduce transactional friction and banking costs, combined with virtual trade corridor frameworks.
- Strategic Partnerships: Despite regional hurdles, India is actively building bilateral support. During high-level exchanges in 2026, India and Italy elevated their

strategic partnership to a "Special Strategic Partnership" and agreed to hold the first IMEC Ministerial meeting in 2026 to take concrete steps toward implementation, alongside signing bilateral MoUs on maritime transport and ports.

5: Tactical Crisis Management and Maritime Protection Assets

In tandem with long-term structural programs, India has deployed tactical defense, security, and administrative assets to manage the immediate fallout of the West Asian hostilities.

1. Naval Deployments and Multinational Collaborative Command

- **Active Patrolling:** The Indian Navy has actively deployed combat vessels off Djibouti, the Gulf of Aden, the North and Central Arabian Sea, and the East Coast of Somalia to perform anti-piracy patrols and escort merchant ships. Since starting anti-piracy patrols in 2008, the navy has safely escorted 3,440 vessels and over 25,000 seafarers.
- **Combined Task Force (CTF) 154 Command:** The Indian Navy assumed command of CTF 154 on February 11, 2026, at the Combined Maritime Forces (CMF) Headquarters in Manama, Bahrain. Led by Cmde Milind M Mokashi, CTF 154 is a multinational training task force focused on maritime domain awareness, maritime interdiction, search and rescue, and building operational capabilities against piracy, trafficking, and irregular threats across the wider Middle East maritime space.
- **Information Fusion Centre-Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR):** Based in Gurugram, India, the center maintains real-time information exchange links with 25 partner nations and over 40 multinational organizations, ensuring comprehensive maritime domain awareness during periods of heightened threat.

2. Domestic Shipping Oversight and Crisis Coordination

- **MMDAC DGComm Centre:** The Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, through the Directorate General of Shipping (DGS), activated a 24/7 monitoring center to perform real-time vessel tracking with mandatory reporting protocols for

vessel owners and managers operating in the Persian Gulf, Strait of Hormuz, Gulf of Oman, and adjoining sea areas.

- Quick Response Team (QRT): A dedicated QRT was created in March 2026 to coordinate across agencies, provide immediate responses to emerging threats at sea, and offer real-time assistance and helpline support to seafarers and their families.
- Inter-Ministerial Services Improvement Group (SIG): Operated under the DPIIT, the SIG regularly convenes roundtables with major shipping lines (such as the Indian National Shipowners' Association and the Container Shipping Line Association) to address logistics bottlenecks, manage freight rates, and implement standard operating procedures for vessel safety.

6: Structural Discussion Frameworks and Discussion Prompts

To assist in analyzing and debating this complex geopolitical topic, the following structural frameworks and discussion prompts are provided:

1. The Energy Sovereignty Paradox: Assess the strategic risks associated with India relying on foreign-flagged vessels to carry 90% of its oil imports. How can India balance immediate chartering needs with the 2047 self-reliance goals outlined in the Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision?
2. Trade Route Diversification vs. Geopolitical Reality: While the IMEC promises a 30% reduction in logistics costs and a 40% reduction in transit time, it traverses highly volatile geographic zones. What alternative regulatory, financial, and physical security measures must India implement to make the corridor viable during active regional conflicts?
3. Diaspora Evacuation Dynamics: Given that over 10 million Indians reside in West Asia, evaluate the MEA's crisis response mechanism. How can India institutionalize a permanent, fast-response evacuation framework that minimizes economic and personal losses for migrant laborers?

4. The Economic Growth Balancing Act: Analyze the fiscal implications of high energy prices halting the global disinflation trend. With India's GDP growth stepping down from 7.5% to 6.4%, what domestic monetary and structural reforms should the government prioritize to buffer the economy from external supply-side shocks?

How to Research Further:

Start with the Five Wives and One Husband formula: Why, What, When, Who, Where and How. Research your portfolio's stance on the agenda through personal websites, videos of speeches given or statements laid. Move to your party policy and possible weak points that could be attacked by the opposing candidate. Further move to "Oppo research" to garner information for Questions or Speeches aimed at questioning the validity of the opposing person's statements. Mention relevant facts, statistics and legislations wherever necessary. The perfect speech in an Indian committee is judged on oratory skills, confidence, Legal and Factual research mentioned, Party or Portfolio stance displayed, relevance in committee, political rhetoric and possible solutions

Sources for additional research-

- 1.Lok Sabha site
- 2.Rajya Sabha site
- 3.Standing committee reports
- 4.Starred chits and unstarred chits of parliament,
- 5.Press bureau of India
- 6.press trust of India
- 7.Rajya sabha tv channel on YouTube
8. Sansad tv channel on YouTube
9. govt verified sources

All the delegates have to compulsorily bring the printout of this document on the day of conference. We expect a policy statement by each delegate, a sample policy statement is shared below. A policy statement is written by a member individually talking about their stance on the agenda. You have to make one single policy statement minimum 500 words covering the agenda. You have to make it on the name and stance of your allocated portfolio.

Sample policy statement

<https://peach-franni-93.tiiny.site>

to keep in mind AI generated policy statements and solutions will be discarded we hope all members make their policy statement as it will be marked, to note this background guide is just for your reference in understanding the agenda and cannot be used as a source/proof in the committee The rules of procedure and committee flow on the first day of the conference will be explained by the executive board